

Minermen Lose Games, Get Hitters

U.T.-El Paso's baseball team may have lost a double-header Saturday, but it gained back two hitters.

Bob Downing, who was hitting around .140 entering the series with the University of Arizona, whipped two home runs and hit 5-7 Saturday.

Glen Villarreal snapped out of a bad hitting slump Saturday with a 6-8 performance.

HOWEVER, Arizona had the guns to outlast the Miners 7-6 and 11-4.

The Miners, 18-24, end the season Friday and Saturday with a three-game series against the University of New Mexico in a battle to decide which team finishes in the cellar of the Western Athletic Conference Southern Division.

"We really threw that first game away," remarked Miner coach Andy Cohen. "We rallied for five runs in the top of the ninth inning to go ahead 6-4. But in the bottom of the ninth the first two Arizona batters walked on eight straight pitches.

"THEN, AFTER a fly out, we had two throwing errors that enabled the runners from first and second to score."

In the second game Arizona hit well off of U.T.-El Paso starter Mike Kruta, scoring three runs in the first and third innings.